



Dan and Daria's Favourite Graphic Organizers

Supporting Kids
Living Life with DLD

A cartoon illustration of a boy and a girl. The boy, on the left, has brown hair, wears glasses, a white t-shirt, and olive green pants. The girl, on the right, has a large afro hairstyle, wears a yellow t-shirt and blue jeans. Two speech bubbles are positioned between them. The top bubble contains text from both characters, and the bottom bubble contains text from the girl.

Hi, we're Dan and Daria!
Expressing ourselves at home and
school can be hard sometimes. But
we've found some tools that are so
helpful!

These graphic organizers help us
visualize our ideas so we can
focus on getting our words out.
We hope they help you too!

Targeted Words in this Pack:

- compare
- predict
- describe
- explain
- summarize
- sequence
- infer
- contrast
- categorize
- hypothesize

Kids with DLD often struggle to understand the difference between important academic words like *summarize*, *compare*, or *predict*. These skills are not only important for school but also for everyday conversations, friendships, and problem-solving.

With *Dan and Daria's Favourite Graphic Organizers*, you can model responses, make thinking visible, and give your child tools they can use to understand and express ideas in the classroom, at home, or out with friends.

Here's How to Get Started:

STEP 01

Select a Skill to Focus On:

Target one word at a time. Consider letting your child select which word to target first.

STEP 02

Review the Target Word Together:

Use the task example and corresponding graphic organizer so your child can visualize concepts easily, decreasing the language demands placed on your child.

STEP 03

Practice and Reflect:

Encourage your child to apply their knowledge by using the target word in a new context that is relevant and meaningful to their life, using the blank graphic organizer.

YOU DON'T NEED TO BE A
TEACHER TO USE THESE!
JUST SIT BESIDE YOUR
CHILD, PICK ONE
ORGANIZER, AND TALK IT
THROUGH TOGETHER.

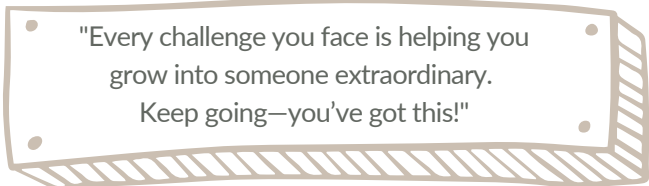
This toolkit helps children with language difficulties become more comfortable with words they'll encounter in school and in social situations.

Our clear definitions, practical examples, and guided practice opportunities can help your child develop confidence when communicating.

Make it Meaningful and Motivating

Show your child how using these target words can help them get what they want. Perhaps your child can *describe* the benefits of a new game they want to purchase or *explain* to you why they should be allowed to stay up later on the weekend.

Kids are more likely to engage if the context is meaningful and motivating.



"Every challenge you face is helping you grow into someone extraordinary.
Keep going—you've got this!"

Compare

1

Definition

To identify similarities and differences between two or more things.

Useful Words/Phrases:

similar, both, alike, in common, different, but, however, on the other hand

Task Example:

"Compare giraffes and zebras."

Giraffes and zebras are **both** animals that live in Africa; they have some things **in common** and some **differences**. **Both** animals eat plants and live in groups, which helps protect them from predators. **However**, giraffes are much taller, with long necks that help them reach leaves high in trees. They are orange with brown spots. Zebras, **on the other hand**, are shorter and have black and white stripes that help them blend in with grass to stay safe. Therefore, giraffes and zebras are **alike** in some ways and **different** in others.

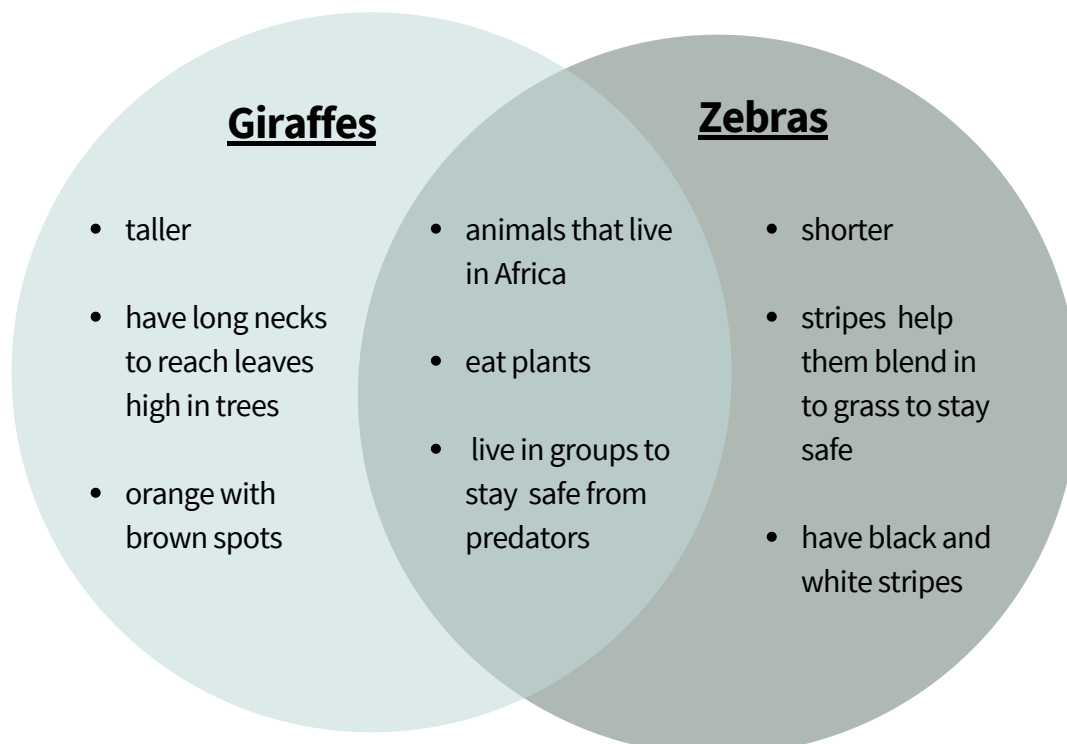
Practice Opportunity:

Compare Minecraft to Roblox.



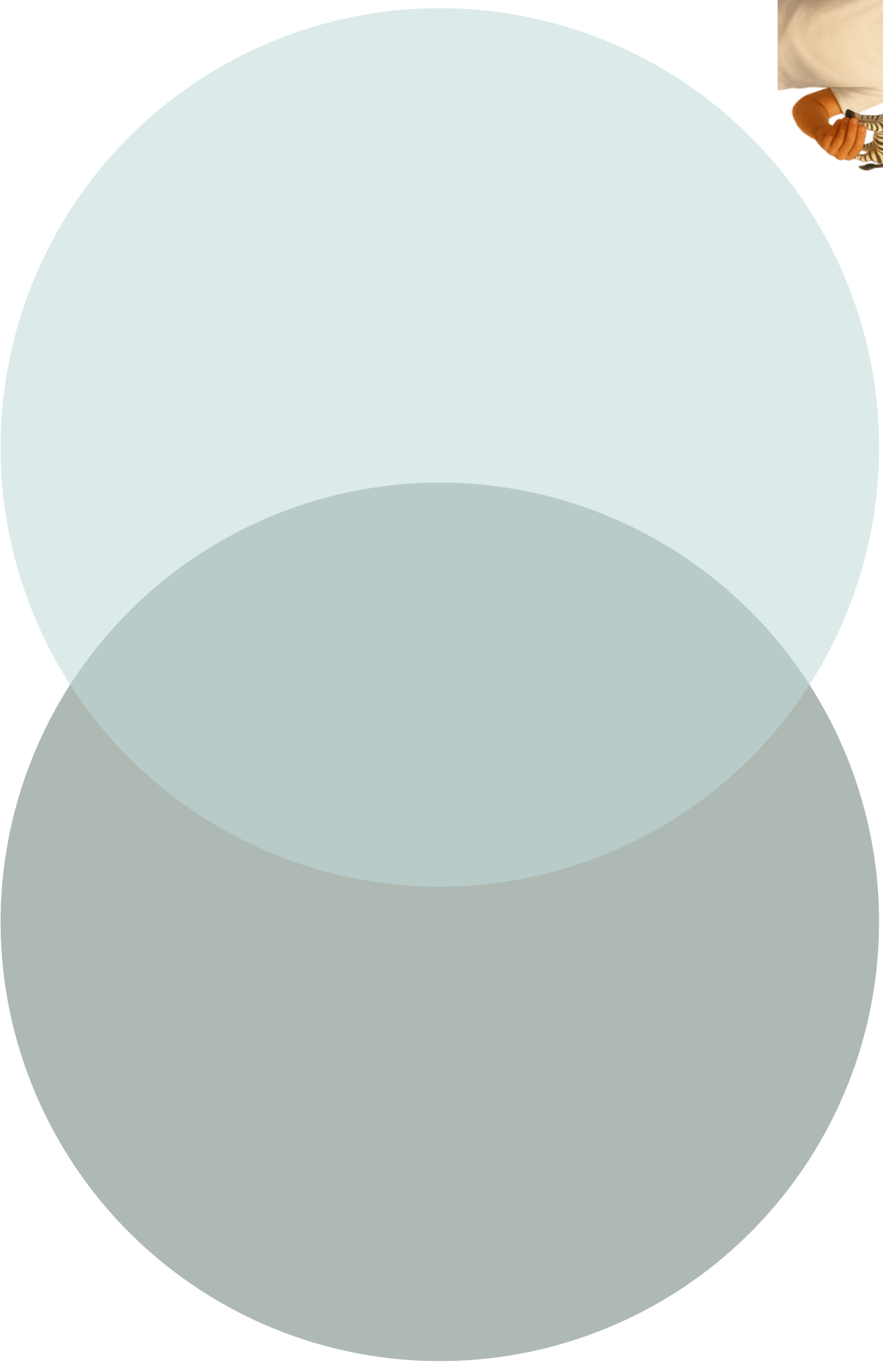
Resource: Venn Diagram Graphic Organizer

VENN DIAGRAM





VENN DIAGRAM



Predict

2

Definition

To say what you think will happen in the future.

Useful Words/Phrases:

I predict, I suspect, there would be, I learned that, I found out

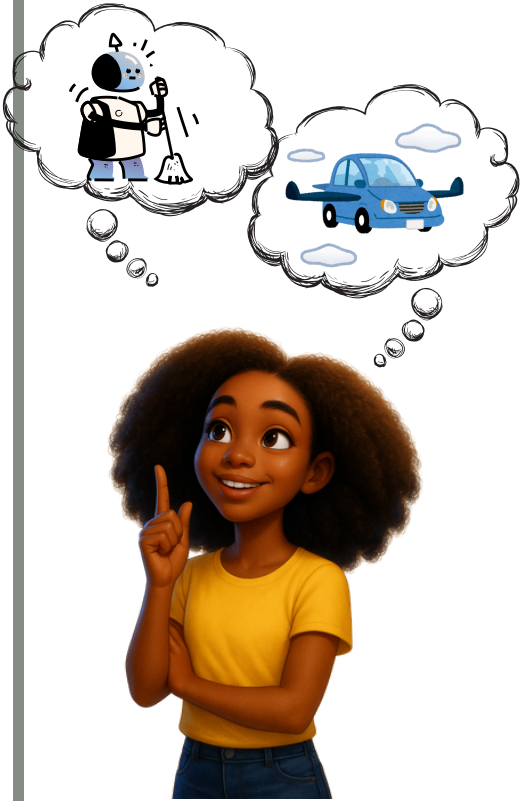
Task Example:

"Predict what life will be like when Joe time travels in chapter 2."

After reading the first chapter of the story, I made three predictions about life in 2123. First, Joe had trouble finding a clean place to swim in 2023. **I predicted that** in 2123, there **would probably be** ways to clean the ocean. After reading, **I learned** this was correct because they had machines that made clean water everywhere! Second, Joe faced traffic problems on the way to work. **I suspected that** in 2123, **there would be** flying cars. This prediction was right because Joe traveled in a flying car. Lastly, Joe worried about world hunger. I predicted that in 2123, world hunger would not be solved. After finishing the story, I found out this was false because special machines grew food fast and helped end hunger!

Practice Opportunity:

Predict what might happen if you don't study for a test.



Resource:

Making Predictions

This graphic organizer guides you in making predictions as you read. It helps you use clues and prior knowledge to form ideas.

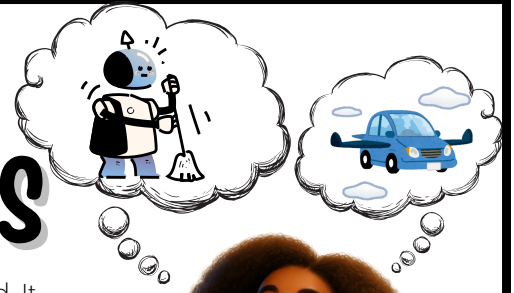
Directions: Write down clues from the text and combine them with what you already know to make a prediction. After reading, check if your prediction was correct.

Clues These come from the text	Prediction What do you think will happen?	Confirmation Was your prediction correct?
Joe had trouble finding a clean place to swim	There would be ways to clean the ocean	Yes. Machines cleaned the ocean!
Joe got stuck in traffic on the way to work	People would invent flying cars	Yes. Joe rode in a flying car!
Joe was concerned with world hunger	World hunger would not be solved	No. Machines grew enough food for all

Making Predictions

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Directions: Write down clues from the text and combine them with what you already know to make a prediction. After reading, check if your prediction was correct.



Clues These come from the text	Prediction What do you think will happen?	Confirmation Was your prediction correct?

Describe

3

Definition

To give details about what something looks like, feels like, sounds like, or acts like.

Useful Words/Phrases:

looks like, including, characteristics, for instance

Task Example:

"Describe a giraffe."

Model Response: "A giraffe is a tall animal that lives in Africa. It has a long neck and legs, which help it reach high up into trees to eat leaves. Giraffes like to eat many kinds of plants, **including** leaves, flowers, and fruits. **For instance**, they love acacia leaves. Giraffes live in grassy places called savannas. One of their special **characteristics** is their spotted fur, which helps them hide from predators, like lions. Giraffes have babies called calves after being pregnant for 15 months. These calves can start walking soon after birth!

Practice Opportunity:

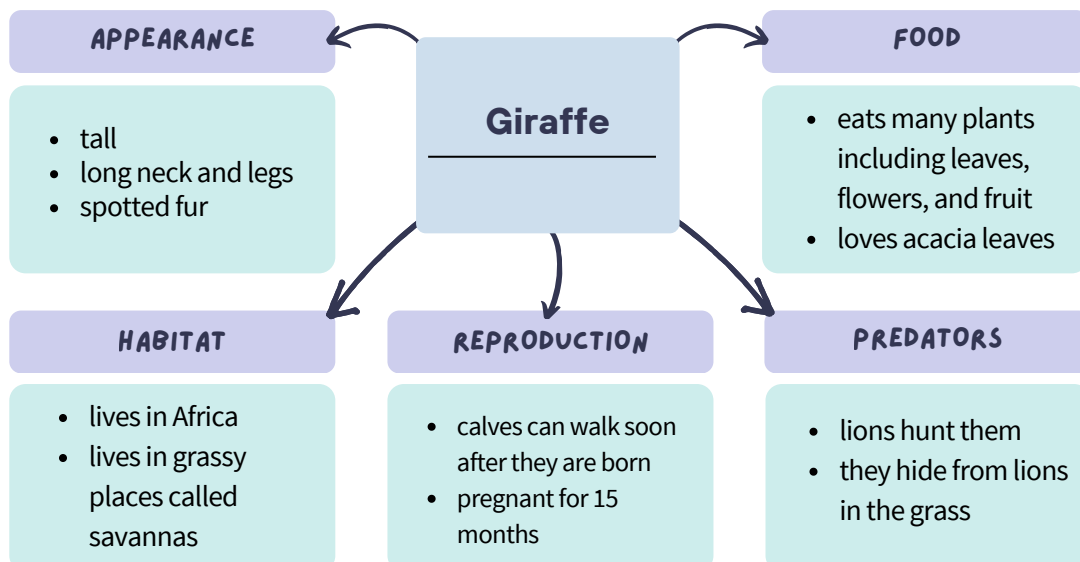
Describe your ideal birthday party.



Resource: Word Web Graphic Organizer

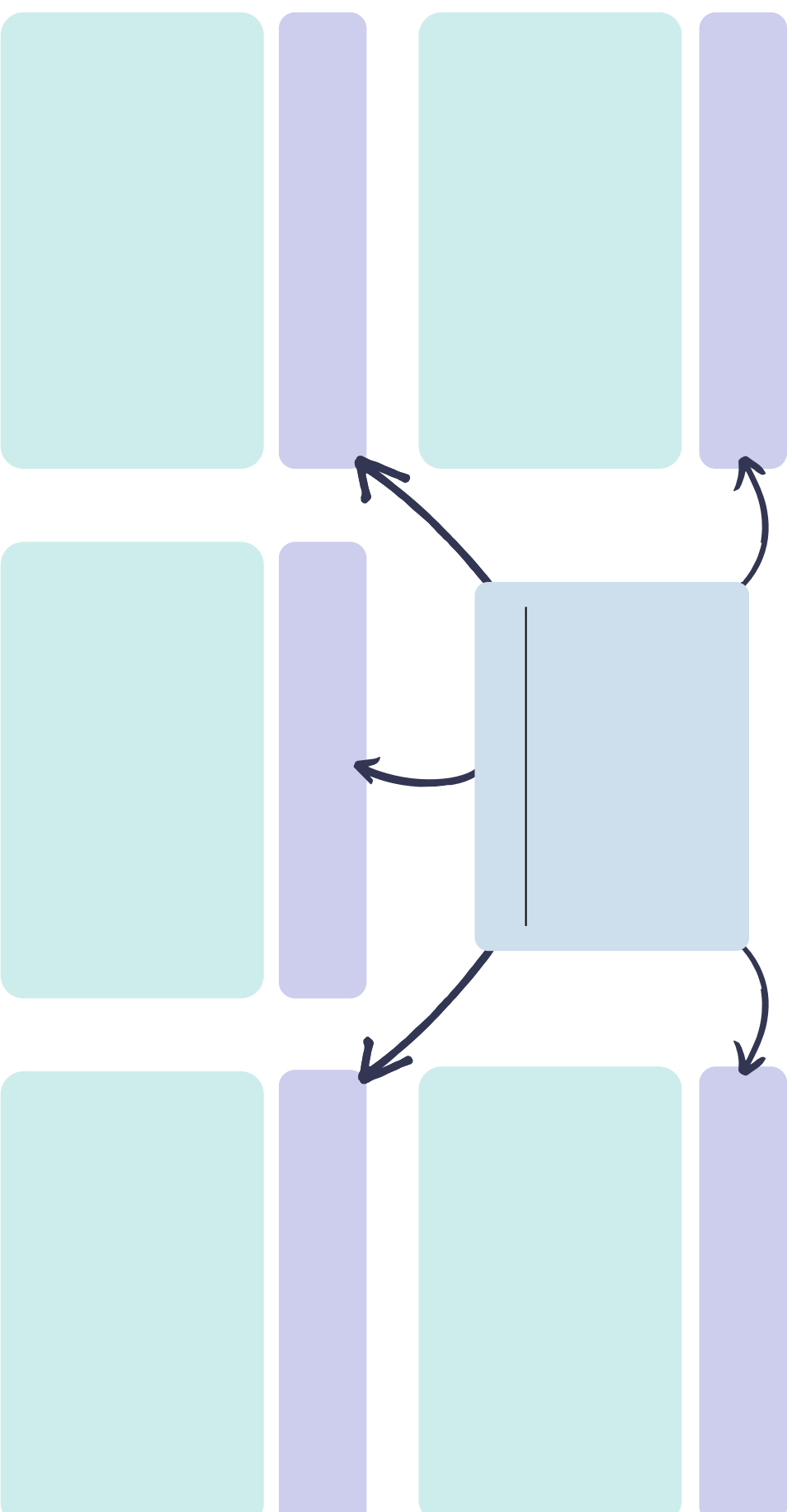


Word Web Graphic Organizer





Word Web Graphic Organizer



Explain

4

Definition

To make something clear or understandable.

Useful Words/Phrases:

because, for example, such as, therefore, first, this means that

Task Example:

"Explain how the water cycle works."

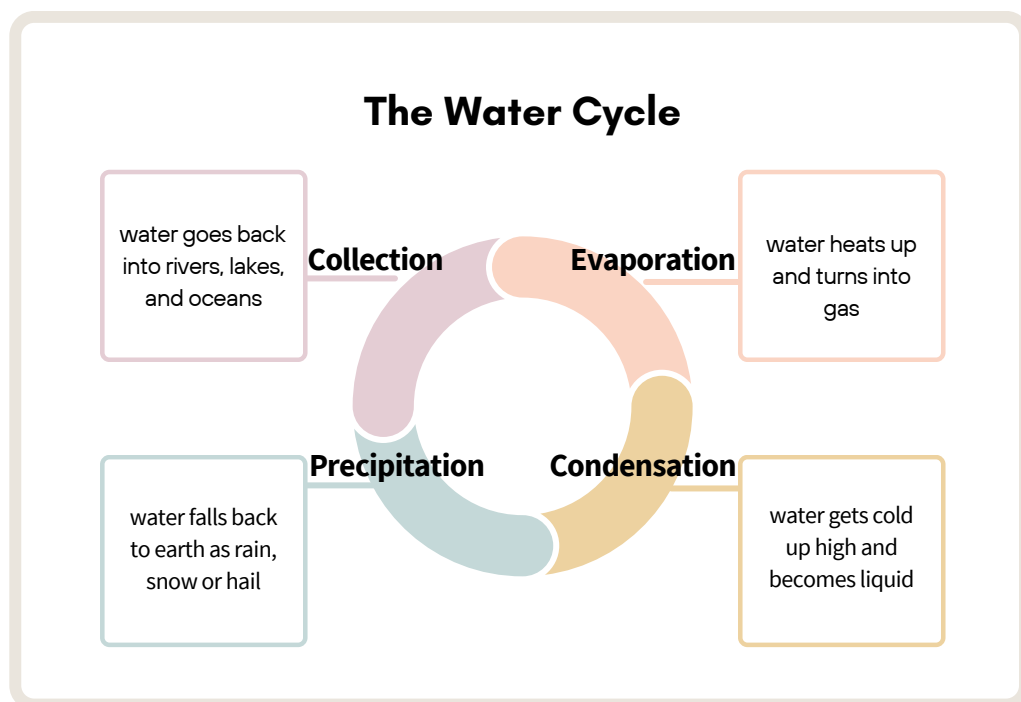
The water cycle is how water moves around the Earth. It has four main parts: evaporation, condensation, precipitation, and collection. First, in evaporation, water from oceans, lakes, or rivers heats up and turns into a gas. This happens **because** the sun makes the water warm enough to rise into the air. Next is condensation. **This means that** water gas goes up high where it's colder. It then turns back into tiny drops, forming clouds. Then comes precipitation, which is when the water falls back to Earth. **For example**, it may fall as rain, snow, or hail. Precipitation happens **because** clouds get too heavy. Finally, in the collection part, the water goes back into rivers, lakes, and oceans. This is a cycle and **therefore**, it will start all over again!

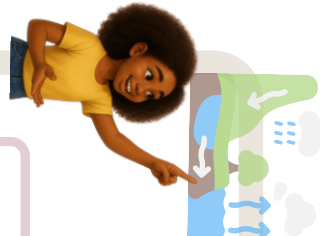
Practice Opportunity:

Explain why staying up later on Friday night is a good idea.



Resource: Flow Chart Graphic Organizer







Summarize

5

Definition

To briefly restate the main ideas or points in a shorter version.

Useful Words/Phrases:

in summary, to sum up, the main point, in conclusion

Task Example:

"Summarize the importance of the Amazon Rainforest."

Model Response:

"In summary, there are three main reasons the Amazon Rainforest is so important and needs to be taken care of. First, it is home to many different plants, animals, and insects that live only there. Second, it helps clean the air. Finally, it is called "the lungs of the Earth" because it produces so much oxygen for us to breathe. **In conclusion**, the Amazon Rainforest is very important, and we need to take care of it."

Practice Opportunity:

Summarize why we should sign you up for soccer/art/ballet camp.



Resource: Summarizing Graphic Organizer

SUMMARY GRAPHIC ORGANIZER

What's the Main Point?

Main Idea:

The Amazon Rainforest is very important and we need to take care of it.

Supporting Idea 1:

It is the only home for many kinds of plants, animals, and bugs.

Supporting Idea 2:

It helps clean the air.

Supporting Idea 3:

It produces oxygen for us to breathe.

Conclusion:

We need to take care of the Amazon Rainforest because it is very important.

SUMMARY GRAPHIC ORGANIZER

What's the main point?



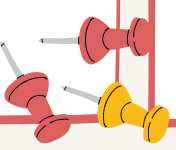
Main Idea:



Supporting Idea 1:

Supporting Idea 2:

Supporting Idea 3:



Conclusion:

Name: _____

Date: _____

STORY SUMMARY



Book Title: _____

Author: _____

Characters: _____

Setting: _____

Summary:

Somebody: Who is the story about?



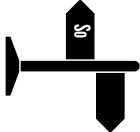
Wanted: What does she/he want to do?



But: What is the problem?



So: What did he/she try to do?



Then: How was the problem solved?



How did the main character change?

Beginning:

Middle:

End:

Sequence

6

Definition

To put things in order according to when they happen or how they should happen.

Useful Words/Phrases:

first, next, then, after that, the next step is, finally

Task Example:

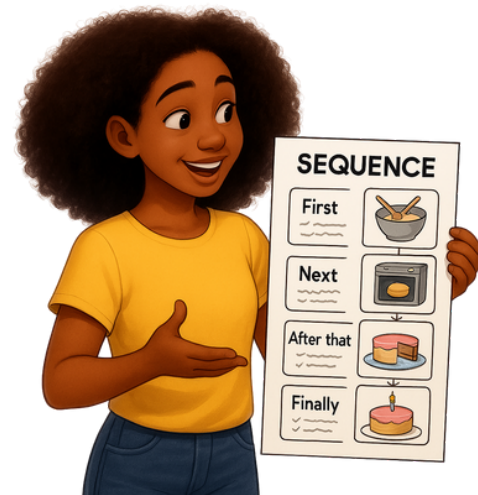
"Sequence the steps involved in baking a cake."

Model Response: "To make a cake, there are several steps to follow.

First, choose a recipe and gather your ingredients. **Next**, mix the wet ingredients in one bowl and the dry ingredients in another. **Then**, combine all the ingredients in one bowl. **After that**, put the batter in a greased pan and bake it in the oven. **The next step is** preparing the frosting. **Finally**, once the cake is cool, spread frosting on top and serve. Be sure to share some with a friend!

Practice Opportunity:

Sequence your steps in getting ready for the Taylor Swift concert.



Resource: Sequence Graphic Organizer

Sequencing

Write or draw the sequences of events.

Title: _____

1 **First**

Choose a recipe and gather the ingredients.

2 **Next**

Mix the dry ingredients in one bowl and wet ingredients in another.

3 **Then**

Combine all the ingredients and pour into a greased pan.

4 **After That**

Bake the cake.

5 **The Next Step Is**

Prepare the frosting while the cake is cooling.

6 **Finally**

Once cool, frost the cake and serve.

Sequencing

Write or draw the sequences of events.

Title: _____



1 First

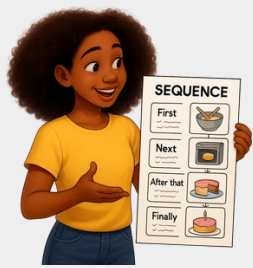
2 Next

3 Then

4 After That

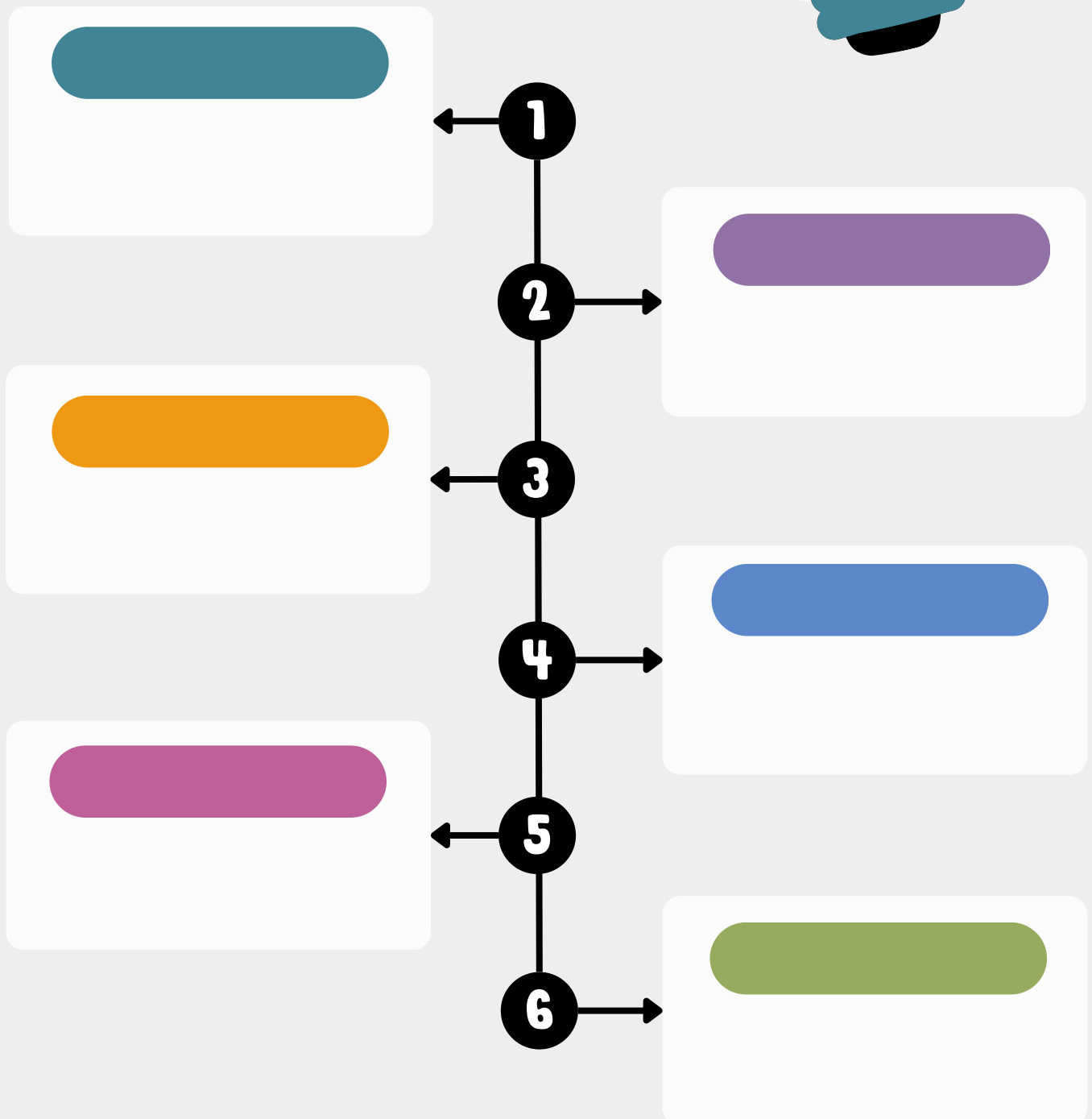
5 The Next Step Is

6 Finally



TIMELINE

GRAPHIC ORGANIZER



SEQUENCE

- First**
I will wash my hands.
- Next**
I will turn on the oven.
- After that**
I will mix the ingredients.
- Finally**
I will bake the cake.

SEQUENCE

First we prepared the ingredients.	
Next we prepared the mixture.	
After that we prepared the structure.	
Finally we prepared the decoration.	

SEQUENCE

First we prepared the ingredients.	
Next we prepared the mixture.	
After that we prepared the structure.	
Finally we prepared the decoration.	

Infer

7

Definition

To make a guess based on clues or evidence.

Useful Words/Phrases:

In the story, I know that...so I infer that, I also read that,

Task Example:

"Make 3 inferences about Geronimo Stilton from your book."

In the story, Geronimo screams and hides when he sees a ghost. **I know that** people often scream when they are scared, **so I infer that** Geronimo is scared of the ghost. Later **in the story**, Geronimo follows Thea's advice on how to solve the mystery. **I know that** people often listen to others who they trust and think are smart, **so I infer that** Geronimo trusts Thea and believes she is a smart mouse. At the end of the story, Geronimo talks about the mistakes he made on his adventure. **I know that** people can learn from their mistakes, **so I infer that** Geronimo becomes wiser after his experiences.

Practice Opportunity:

Based on what you know about your dad and the mood he is in, infer the best time to ask him to increase your allowance.



Resource: Infer Graphic Organizer

Making Inferences Use this graphic organizer to help you make inferences about any text, video, or image you have to close read or analyze.		
 Clues from text (evidence/information from the text)	 What I already know (my background knowledge or experience)	 What I infer (my background knowledge or experience)
<i>The text says that...</i>	<i>I know that...</i>	<i>I infer...</i>
Geronimo screams and hides when he sees the ghost	People scream and hide when they are scared	Geronimo is scared of the ghost
Geronimo listens to Thea's advice on how to solve the mystery	We usually listen to the advice of those we trust and think are smart	Geronimo must trust Thea and believe she is smart
Geronimo talks about the mistakes he made on his adventure	We can learn from our mistakes	Geronimo becomes wiser

Making Inferences

Use this graphic organizer to help you make inferences about any text, video, or image you have to close read or analyze.



Clues from text
(evidence/information from the text)



What I already know
(my background knowledge or experience)



What I infer
(my background knowledge or experience)



The text says...

I already know...

I infer...

Contrast

8

Definition

To focus on the differences between two or more things.

Useful Words/Phrases:

however, but, although, on the other hand

Task Example:

"Contrast living in the city with living in the countryside."

Model Response: "The city is crowded and noisy; **however**, the countryside is quiet and open. **Although** people live in both places, they live much closer together in the city. If you live in the countryside, you may need to drive very far to get to a hospital or movie theater, **but** if you live in the city, those places are usually close by. The air can get quite polluted in the city but in the countryside it is usually much cleaner. Some people think there are way more fun things to do in the city; **however**, some people think living in the countryside is much more fun."

Practice Opportunity:

Contrast dogs and cats. Describe two ways they are different.



Resource: T-Chart Graphic Organizer

T Chart Graphic Organiser	
Organise your information using the headings below.	
Topic: Living in the city vs countryside	
Cities	Countryside
• crowded and noisy • people live closer together • places you need like hospitals are usually close by • air can get polluted • some people think it has more fun things to do	• quiet and open • people live further apart • places you need like hospitals might be far away • air is usually cleaner • some people think it has more fun things to do

T Chart

Graphic Organiser



Organise your information using the headings below.

Topic:

--	--

Categorize

9

Definition

To place things into groups based on shared characteristics.

Useful Words/Phrases:

type, group, sort, kind, categories

Examples:

"Categorize the animals based on where they live. List each type of habitat and the animals that belong to it."

Animals can be divided into two main **categories**: sea animals and land animals. Sea animals live in the ocean, lakes, or rivers. Some examples are fish, whales, sharks, and dolphins. These animals have special body parts to help them swim, like fins and tails. Another **type** of animal is land animals. They live on the land, in forests, deserts, or jungles. Examples of land animals include lions, elephants, dogs, and birds. Animals in this **group** have legs for walking and many have fur or feathers to keep them warm.

Practice Opportunity:

Categorize your favorite books or shows into types, such as adventure or mystery.



Resource: Categorize/ Classification Graphic Organizer



CATEGORIZATION CHART

A tool to help you **classify**, **sort** or **categorize** your ideas after reading or during research.

Types of Animals	
Land Animals	Sea Animals
- live in forests, deserts or jungles - have legs for walking and many have fur or feathers - examples include lions, elephants and dogs	- live in oceans, lakes or rivers - have special body parts to help them swim like tails and fins - examples include fish, whales and dolphins



CATEGORIZATION CHART

A tool to help you **classify**, **sort** or **categorize** your ideas after reading or during research.

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CATEGORIZATION CHART

A tool to help you **classify**, **sort** or **categorize** your ideas after reading or during research.

Hypothesize

10

Definition

To make an educated guess about what might happen or why something is the way it is.

Useful Words/Phrases:

if, might, possibly, could, I think/guess

Examples:

"Hypothesize what might happen to a plant if it didn't get any more sunlight."

Model Response: "I'm going to **guess** what **might** happen to plants **if** they don't get any sunlight. Without sunlight, they **could possibly** stop growing or they **might** even die! Sunlight is important because it gives plants the energy they need to make food. **If** plants don't have sunlight, they **could** get small and weak or maybe die. It's also **possible** that the plants **might** not have their usual green colour because sunlight helps plants stay green. So, without sunlight, plants **might** not grow properly or survive."

Practice Opportunity:

Hypothesize what would happen if you did your chores for a week without any reminders.



Resource: Hypothesize Graphic Organizer

Hypothesize Graphic Organizer



TITLE: Can Plants Grow in the Dark?

QUESTION:

I wonder...
what would happen to a plant
if it stopped getting any
sunlight.

HYPOTHESIS:

I think...
they might stop growing or
might die.

EXPERIMENT:

I noticed...

Dark room: The plants started to turn yellow and then they withered up.

Bright room: The plants grew well and were healthy with nice green leaves and a green stem.

CONCLUSION:

I learned...

Plants need sunlight to be healthy.

Hypothesize Graphic Organizer



TITLE:

QUESTION:

I wonder...

HYPOTHESIS:

I think...

EXPERIMENT:

I noticed...

CONCLUSION:

I learned...

What's NEXT



JOIN OUR ONLINE COMMUNITY

Come chat and learn with other parents, teachers, and therapists who are passionate about helping kids with their language skills.



VISIT US ON YOUTUBE

Watch *Life with DLD: The Dan and Daria Podcast* with your child!

If you want more practical tools and examples to engage with your child at home, take our free parent course!



CHECK OUT OUR WEBSITE

We have more resources to support you on this journey. Don't forget to join our mailing list!



GRAB A COPY OF OUR BOOKS

Representation is so important! Our books follow Dan and Daria, relatable characters navigating life with DLD. These stories offer hope and inspiration, helping kids feel seen while teaching families and educators what it's like to live with DLD.

Your child's future is bright—and you're an essential part of that.

We know the challenges that come with DLD can be daunting, but we also know how transformative your support can be.

At Empowered DLD Parenting, we're here to help you build skills, strategies, and confidence to navigate this path with purpose.

You already have what it takes; we're just here to guide you.

Take that next step today.

Small changes lead to big progress, and together, we can help your child reach their full potential.



Jinean & Camesha

Speech-Language Pathologist &
Elementary School Teacher

Hello!

We're a teacher and SLP duo passionate about supporting families navigating DLD. As parents, we know how complex raising kids can be! Our mission is to empower parents, teachers, and therapists to feel confident supporting children with DLD. We're also working to make DLD as widely known as conditions like ADHD and autism

Jinean and Camesha

💡 Our Final Tips for Parents

- Keep it short: Try 5–10 minutes at a time so your child stays focused and positive.
- Model first: Show your child how to use the organizer, then let them give it a try.
- Make it visual: Point, draw, and use gestures to connect the ideas.
- Celebrate effort: Praise your child for trying, even if the answer isn't perfect.

A Friendly Reminder

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Jinean and Camesha
Speech-Language Pathologist & Elementary School Teacher Team